SOLVE PHASE

Conducting a brainstorm

Executing a brainstorm isn't unique; holding a productive brainstorm is. Great brainstorms are ones that set the stage for fresh and generative thinking through simple guidelines and an open and collaborative environment. Use this when you're just kicking-off a new project and want to hit the ground running with big ideas that will move your team forward.

- **15 minutes** to prepare
- **30-60 minutes** to collaborate
- **3-8 people** recommended

Created in partnership with

Meta

Modified by

IIT Madras
BS Degree

For any feedback or suggestions on the Mural canvas, email ohyeem@study.iitm.ac.in

Team & Project Details

September - December 2024

Add your project details or sector here

TEAM NO. 3

Name	Roll No.
Dipanjan Rout	21f3002560
Kartikey Bhandari	21f3002484
Trisit Ganguly	21f2000634
Pranshu Jaiswal	21f3001310

Before you collaborate

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going.

15 minutes

A **Set the stage for creativity and inclusivity**
Go over the brainstorming rules and keep them in front of your team while brainstorming to encourage collaboration, optimism, and creativity.

1. **Encourage wild ideas** (If none of the ideas sound a bit ridiculous, then you are filtering yourself too much.)
2. **Defer judgement** (This can be as direct as harsh words or as subtle as a condescending tone or talking over one another.)
3. **Build on the ideas of others** ("I want to build on that idea" or the use of "yes, and...")
4. **Stay focused on the topic at hand**
5. **Have one conversation at a time**
6. **Be visual** (Draw and/or upload to show ideas, whenever possible.)
7. **Go for quantity**

B **Interested in learning more?**
Check out the Meta Think Kit website for additional tools and resources to help your team collaborate, innovate and move ideas forward with confidence.

Open the website →

Systematic Problem Solving

TRIZ

The TRIZ matrix complies proven principles to address your current technological challenges. Examine the 40 established TRIZ Principles to spark fresh ideas for solving new problems and crafting innovative solutions.

Open the website →

1 Choose your best "How Might We" Questions

Share the top 3 brainstorm questions that you created and let the group determine where to begin by selecting one question to move forward with based on what seems to be the most promising for idea generation in the areas you are trying to impact.

10 minutes

QUESTION
How mgnt we create learning journeys that combine self-paced courses with real-world, industry-backed projects?

QUESTION
How might we encourage mentors and alumni to actively participate by making their contributions visible and valued?

QUESTION
How mgnt we create a feedback loop where industry experts provide actionable advice on student projects?

QUESTION
How might we design a system where recruiters can post jobs and directly view student profiles based on verified skills and projects?

2 Brainstorm solo

Have each participant begin in the "solo brainstorm space" by silently brainstorming ideas and placing them into the template. This "silent-storming" avoids group-think and creates an inclusive environment for introverts and extroverts alike. Set a time limit. Encourage people to go for quantity.

10 minutes

3 Brainstorm as a group

Have everyone move their ideas into the "group sharing space" within the template and have the team silently read through them. As a team, sort and group them by thematic topics or similarities. Discuss and answer any questions that arise. Encourage "Yes, and..." and build on the ideas of other people along the way.

15 minutes

TIP
You can use the **Voting session** tool above to focus on the strongest ideas.

Ideas...

- Alumni-led live project mentoring groups.
- Real time feedback from mentors via online connect
- Verified skill badges shown directly on student profiles
- Hiring manager review system for student submissions.
- Social sharing: show off skills on Linkedin/ Instagram.
- Mental well being check ins
- AI-driven ranking system for recruiters to shortlist fast.
- AI powered interview question banks linked to course content.

4 Decide your focus

Give each person two icons to vote which idea should your team focus on.

5 minutes

Dipanjan

Kartikey

Pranshu

Trisit

After you collaborate

A brainstorm like this typically results in a handful of promising ideas that you can carry forward and act upon.

Quick add-ons

Cluster related ideas
Look for patterns or similarities in the standout ideas. Could any be combined together to form a stronger concept? Cluster similar ideas and label each cluster with a theme.

Vote on the most promising ideas
Narrow your focus to only the strongest few ideas by holding a **Voting Session**. Give each person 2 votes

Keep moving forward

2x2 Prioritization matrix
Build shared understanding and make collective decisions for moving ideas forward.

Open the template →

Storyboarding
Show existing and/or future consumer experiences through the act of sketching.

Open the template →

Pre-mortem
Harness the collective experience and wisdom of the team, before the project even starts.

Open the template →

Need some inspiration?
See a finished version of this template to kickstart your work.

Open example →